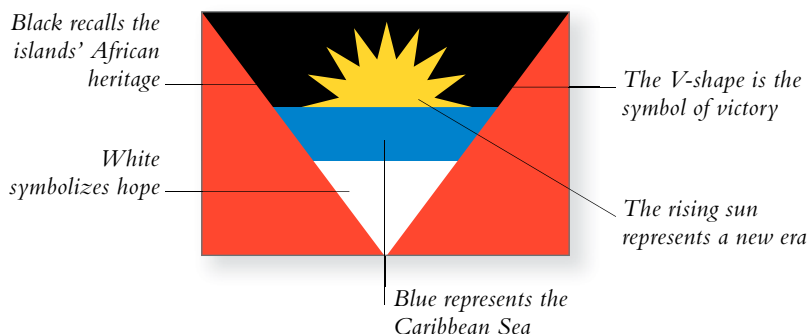


Antigua & Barbuda

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** February 27, 1967 **Usage:** National and Civil



North America



From 1632 until formal independence was granted in 1981, **Antigua** and its neighbor **Barbuda** were British colonies.

The flag dates from the achievement of self-government in 1967 and was the winning design in a competition which over 600 local people entered.

THE SYMBOLISM OF THE FLAG

The designer, Reginald Samuel, interpreted it as representing the sun rising against the background of the peoples' African heritage in a new era. The overall V-shape stands for victory. It is on a red background which symbolizes the dynamism of the population. Blue is for the sea and white is for hope.

THE NEW NATIONAL FLAG

The flag was retained unchanged when Antigua became independent.

Barbuda, does not have a separate flag, although there is one for Redonda, an uninhabited island whose "throne" is claimed by several rival "monarchs."

THE NATIONAL ARMS

The coat of arms was granted in 1977 and depicts a shield with a sugar mill, once the primary industry, on a background of white and blue waves. Above this is a sun on a black background. The shield stands on a sea island. The crest is a pineapple from the arms of the former colony of the Leeward Islands, of which Antigua was once a part. Beneath is a scroll with the national motto—"Each endeavouring, all achieving."